

Generative AI reading list

The four cohort papers plus the surrounding work, ordered so each one makes the next easier. If you read only four, read the ones marked [core].

Foundations

- Vaswani et al. (2017) - Attention Is All You Need. arXiv:1706.03762. The architecture everything else assumes.
- Brown et al. (2020) - Language Models are Few-Shot Learners. arXiv:2005.14165. Where in-context learning enters the picture.

Retrieval

- [core] Lewis et al. (2020) - Retrieval-Augmented Generation for Knowledge-Intensive NLP Tasks. arXiv:2005.11401.
- Karpukhin et al. (2020) - Dense Passage Retrieval for Open-Domain QA. arXiv:2004.04906. The retriever half, in detail.
- [core] Asai et al. (2023) - Self-RAG. arXiv:2310.11511. Retrieval as a control decision rather than a fixed step.
- Gao et al. (2023) - Retrieval-Augmented Generation for Large Language Models: A Survey. arXiv:2312.10997. Useful map once you know the terrain.

Agents and tool use

- [core] Yao et al. (2022) - ReAct. arXiv:2210.03629.
- [core] Schick et al. (2023) - Toolformer. arXiv:2302.04761.
- Shinn et al. (2023) - Reflexion: Language Agents with Verbal Reinforcement Learning. arXiv:2303.11366.
- Wei et al. (2022) - Chain-of-Thought Prompting. arXiv:2201.11903. Read it for what it does not claim.

Evaluation and failure

- Es et al. (2023) - RAGAS: Automated Evaluation of Retrieval Augmented Generation. arXiv:2309.15217.
- Ji et al. (2022) - Survey of Hallucination in Natural Language Generation. arXiv:2202.03629.
- Liu et al. (2023) - Lost in the Middle: How Language Models Use Long Contexts. arXiv:2307.03172.

How to read one of these

Abstract, then figures, then the experimental setup - in that order, before any of the prose. Most of what you need is in the setup: what they compared against, on what data, and what they held fixed.

Then read the ablations, which is where the honest limitations usually live. The related-work section is the last thing worth your time, not the first.

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